

Claims & Argument Structure

Workbook 1 - Learn - Focused practice

Directions

Work slowly. Identify exactly what the source says before you decide what the evidence can support.

Exercise 1

A school newsletter says the campus should add two refill stations. It notes that students bought 4,200 bottled drinks last semester and that the existing station is busiest at lunch.

Task: Which statement is the main claim?

- A. Students bought 4,200 bottled drinks.
- B. The campus should add two refill stations.
- C. The existing station is busiest at lunch.
- D. Lunch is the busiest time on campus.

Exercise 2

A supervisor recommends a short safety refresher before the busy season. She says new workers made most checklist errors last year, and a 20-minute refresher could review the three most missed steps.

Task: Which statement is a supporting claim?

- A. The company exists.
- B. A refresher could target the steps workers miss most often.
- C. Last year had twelve months.
- D. Safety matters in every workplace.

Exercise 3

A council member proposes testing weekend bus service. First, she explains that hospital staff report few transport options on Sundays. Next, she cites ridership estimates. Finally, she asks for a three-month trial.

Task: How is the argument organized?

- A. Problem, supporting evidence, proposed test.
- B. Chronological history of the bus company.
- C. Two unrelated opinions followed by a definition.
- D. A cause is stated and then disproved.

Exercise 4

"The park should keep one gate open until 9 p.m. because evening walkers currently exit through an unlit side path."

Task: Which part is evidence rather than the claim?

- A. The park should keep one gate open until 9 p.m.
- B. Evening walkers currently exit through an unlit side path.
- C. The park has gates.
- D. Walking is healthy.

Answer reasoning

Check your reasoning, not only your answer.

For every question, compare your reasoning with the explanation. If you missed the item, identify the exact step where your reasoning changed the source or used evidence for the wrong job.

Exercise 1

Best answer: B. The campus should add two refill stations.

Why: That is the position the writer wants accepted. The purchase total and usage detail are evidence.

Exercise 2

Best answer: B. A refresher could target the steps workers miss most often.

Why: It gives a reason the proposed refresher could be useful; it supports the recommendation.

Exercise 3

Best answer: A. Problem, supporting evidence, proposed test.

Why: Each part performs a clear role in building the recommendation.

Exercise 4

Best answer: B. Evening walkers currently exit through an unlit side path.

Why: It is a factual condition offered to support the recommendation.

Mistake check

For every miss, label the reason: wrong claim, evidence mismatch, too broad or too certain, reasoning gap, source or format confusion, or rushed reading. Then write one sentence explaining what you will check next time.